REAL ESTATE PROFESSIONALS NETWORK | MEMBER RESOURCE

2026 Housing Market Outlook

Annual Market Report - Member Edition

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REPN

1. Executive Summary

The 2026 housing market continues its measured normalization. Existing-home sales are projected to rise 4.8 percent year over year as mortgage rates settle into the 5.9 to 6.4 percent band. Inventory has improved for the seventh consecutive quarter, yet remains roughly 18 percent below pre-pandemic norms in major metropolitan areas.

Median list prices grew 3.1 percent nationally, with the strongest appreciation concentrated in Midwest metros offering relative affordability. Days on market averaged 34, up slightly from 29 in 2025, signaling healthier negotiating conditions for buyers.

For REPN members, the practical takeaway is clear: buyers are regaining leverage in staged markets, while well-priced inventory in strong school districts continues to draw multiple offers within the first weekend.

2. Regional Highlights

The Northeast recorded the fastest absorption rate at 26 median days on market. The Sun Belt saw a moderation in price growth, with Austin and Phoenix posting their first flat quarters since 2020. Florida coastal markets remain bifurcated by insurance costs, which now add an average of 340 dollars per month to carrying expenses.

Midwest markets led the nation in affordability index improvement, driven by income growth outpacing a modest 2.4 percent price gain. Chicago, Columbus, and Kansas City all registered sub-4.0 months of supply.

3. Implications for Your Business

Members should expect longer decision cycles and place renewed emphasis on buyer consultations, rate buydown education, and listing preparation services. The data suggests agents who systematized weekly seller updates retained 31 percent more listings in 2026.

The full report includes metro-level tables, affordability worksheets, and a downloadable presentation deck for client seminars.